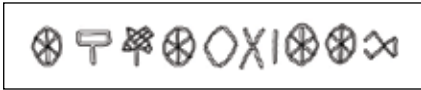


cipher. The cipher is very well known because it is easy to understand and implement and appears unbreakable to beginners. This is where it acquired its reputation of being unbreakable. Spurred on by the myth, a number of people have tried to implement the encryption scheme of this cipher, only to have them broken. Charles Babbage was the first person to have broken a variant of this cipher. The main weakness of this cipher is the repeating nature of its key. If the key's length can be correctly guessed, then the cipher text essentially becomes a combination of interwoven ciphers, which individually are easily broken. Efforts were made to improve this cipher, which led to the development of the one-time pad.

Indus valley script

The term Indus valley script refers to the strings of symbols associated with the Indus valley civilization in use during the middle of the second millennium BC. It is not generally accepted that this script is used to record this language. The first publication of Harrapan seals dates back to the



Indus valley script

1870s. A number of objects bearing symbols from the Indus valley script have been discovered in the past few years. It was believed that this script is related to

the Brahmi script. After multiple attempts to decipher the script, there is still no success in sight and it is still listed as undeciphered. The language for which this script was used has also not been identified yet. Over the years, a number of solutions have been proposed, but none have been widely accepted. One of the biggest challenges in the deciphering process is that no language has been identified, although some words from the Rigveda are sometimes used for comparison. The fact that the average length of the inscriptions is quite small only adds to the complexity. Further, no bilingual texts have been found. The topic is extremely popular among amateur researchers and various decipherment claims have been seen, though none of them have found any recognition.

Beale ciphers

The Beale ciphers are three ciphers which state the location of a buried treasure worth about \$63 million in today's money. Two of the ciphers describe (unessential) details such as the contents of the treasure and